

Q.4a (20 marks): Main socio-cultural attributes of hunters-gatherers, pastoralists and intensive agriculturists

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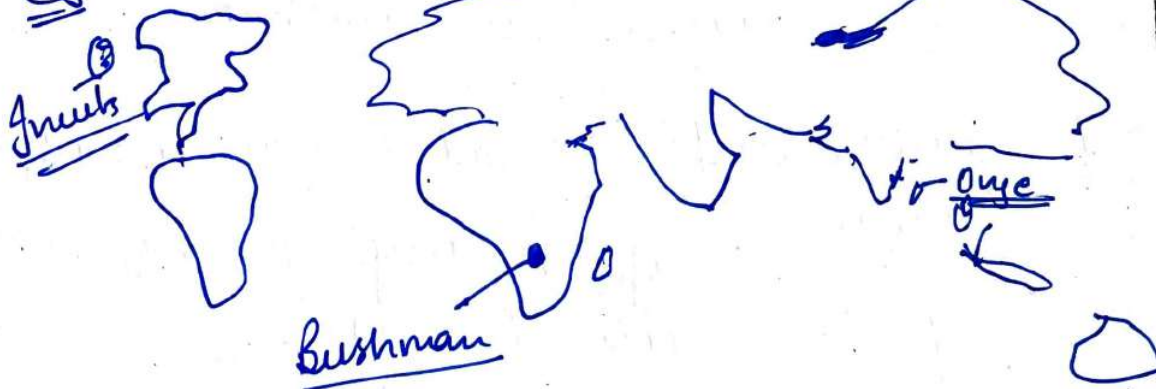
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Since the emergence of Homo Sapiens and even before that, they have used various modes for subsistence. Some were hunter-gatherers, pastoralists some were agriculturist.

Attributes

① Hunter-gatherers → subsistence based on hunting wild animals, gathering and foraging.

eg Bushman - Kalahari, Inuits Chukchee



Socio-cultural attributes

1. Polity → egalitarian society so

absence of leadership at top. Sonatun
part time leaders for hunting
- marriage

2. Organisation - kinship relations are
important - system of reciprocity
(ex) Big game sharing.

3. Economy : - Production : → can be in
group or individual
(ex) Blackfoot Indians
Distribution - no ownership,
egalitarian.
Consumption - immediate, no
storage (ex) Bushman
surplus in winter.

4. Marriage and family → follow various types
of marriage (ex) By trial
in Cherchus
family - no strict notion,
usually elders are superior, younger
are children.

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② Pastoralists - the people has subsistence by changing places, have cattle for feeding. usually in place with vast area (ex) Kaziks, Todas, Nucas.

1. Polity - part time organisation, no head leaders

2. Organisation → form intermediate size group, larger than hunter-gatherers.

3. Economy → depend on cattle for products (eg) Nucas studied by Evans-Pritchard
→ occasional hunting is also done
→ kills animal in time of distress.

4. Marriage, family, Kinship, lineage or clan based society
→ Kinship - can be

(Marriage - by exchange, by mutual consent, give bride price

family - nuclear and extended family.

3. Intensive Agriculture

1. Policy → well-organised and
lead at top.

2. Organisation - huge population
density and well organised
settlements.

3. Economy → trade and cash based
→ surplus stored for future
→ production → lead to

land ownership based stratification

4. Marriage, family - marriage - usually
Kinship monogamy, polygamy -
family - extended family
to avoid land fragmentation
Kinship - very important.

It can be said that socio-cultural
matrix gives holistic picture of
patterns of subsistence.